FOOD FROM THOUGHT

SCALING UP: Home Kitchen to Commercial Kitchen

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What will be covered

Time to
Scale up?

From Home Kitchen to
Commercial Kitchen

Finding your
Solution

TIME TO SCALE UP?

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When do you know your business is ready?

- Consistent Demand beyond Home Capacity
- Need for Food Safety Compliance & Liability Insurance
- Financial Feasibility
- Turning Down Business due to high demand

Time to consider a commercial kitchen or pilot plant facility.

FROM HOME KITCHEN TO COMMERCIAL KITCHEN

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Home Kitchen to Commercial Kitchen

Recipe
Scale Up

Ingredient
Sourcing

Process
Scale Up

Compliance

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Recipe Scale Up

Recipe Scale-up isn't as simple as multiplying your batch sizes

Recipe conversion

- Move to metrics.
- Translate to % for easier scale up.
- Ingredient yields when prepared at larger scale may differ and need adjustment.

Other considerations

- Ingredients may not behave in the same way – adjust or change to achieve desired result.
- An ingredient may be too expensive to meet cost target -substitute.
- Consider how you will purchase ingredients.
- An ingredient's stability may not meet the needs of your new process (colour, texture).

Ingredient Sourcing

Dos & Don'ts

DON'T assume your ingredient/packaging sourcing strategy will stay the same.

- You may need to rewrite a recipe/formula to hit your price point.
- Specialty ingredients – may be difficult to source in larger quantities. Your existing supplier may not be able to source larger quantities.

DO consider storage impacts and shelf life.

- Delivery and storage may be impacted – larger volumes may require increased chiller/dry store/freezer capacity.
- Short shelf life ingredients purchased in larger quantities will need to be managed carefully to avoid excess waste/cost.

DO consider documentation and QA impacts.

- Documentation and quality assurance procedures could be impacted e.g. temperature monitoring, pest control, specification management.

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Process Scale Up

Dos & Don'ts

DON'T ignore the complexities of your process

- What type of mixing are you trying to accomplish (folding vs beating)?
- Will you need different types of equipment?
- The length of processing time (cooking/baking/mixing etc.) may change.
- Do you have ingredient add-ins? Will you need to re-evaluate the order of additions?

DO consider changing your ingredient delivery methodology

- Handling of ingredients may need to change – purchase pack size
- Additional process steps may need to be considered e.g. tempering

DO factor in ingredient kill steps.

- Products must not contain harmful microorganisms
- A kill step (cooking, pasteurizing, or a pathogen-killing wash) is typically needed to ensure food safety
- Do you have the necessary internal expertise, or should you seek outside support?
- Need a robust HACCP plan to ensure food safety.

Process Scale Up

Dos & Don'ts

DO consider the impact of larger product quantities on heating and cooling

- Larger surface area/greater volume will impact heat transfer - heating and cooling.
- How will the heat treatment impact the flavor and color of the product?
- Will the heat treatment affect the shelf life?
- Will heating impact your raw material selection and order of additions?
- Once cooked, how fast can you cool a product without affecting the quality?
- Do you have the proper facilities to support heating and cooling changes?

DON'T overlook yield losses when costing

- e.g. Getting a thick product out of a large jacket kettle as opposed to a pot may be trickier.

DO consider production requirements and future needs when deciding on commercial kitchen vs contract manufacturing....

Compliance

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Make compliance with food safety regulations a priority

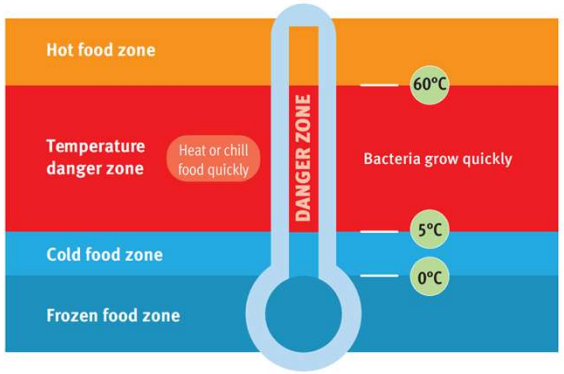
- How long does it take for a large batch of product to reach cooking temperature?
- How long does it take for a large batch to cool?
- How long can refrigerated products be left out before they become unsafe?
- HACCP audit & certification
- Food Safety audit and compliance certification

Evaluate cleaning methods

- Changes in formulation and equipment sizing impact cleaning.
- Are the walls, floor and ceiling of your facility made of materials that won't trap microorganisms?
- Are the floor drains easily cleanable and sanitary?
- Do you have the capabilities to wash all of your equipment?
- Are your existing cleaning chemicals still effective with the new process?
- Will you need to source chemicals from a new supplier?

Validate your shelf life

HACCP AUSTRALIA FOOD SAFETY PROGRAMME CERTIFICATION



Compliance

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Label Compliance with Food Standards Code AU & NZ (FSANZ)

- Ingredient labelling
- Allergen labelling
- Nutrition information panel
- Weights and Measures guidelines

Packaging Compliance

- All packaging materials are suitable for food contact.
- Packaging materials are compatible with processing parameters.
- Sealing complies with food safety requirements for micro stability and quality.

FOOD STANDARDS Australia • New Zealand
Te Mana Kounga Kai – Ahitereiria me Aotearoa

Our new NPC is here!

Check out our new Nutrition Panel Calculator.

Statement of Ingredients

Ingredients:
Water, vegetable oil, vinegar, sugar, tomato paste. capsicum, salt, **egg** yolk, thickener (1412), **almonds**, parmesan cheese (**milk**), garlic, wheat flour, flavour (wheat maltodextrin, **sesame** oil) antioxidant (320).

Summary statement

Contains: egg, almond, milk, wheat, gluten, sesame.

Source: 2021 Food Industry Guide to Allergens Management and Labelling for Australia and New Zealand

FINDING YOUR SOLUTION

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Commercial Kitchens

Pilot Plant Services

Factory Fit Outs

Contract Manufacturers

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Commercial Kitchens

Commercial Kitchens can offer flexible, no lock in contracts e.g. rent by the hour or more long term arrangements

Melbourne:

http://cookingspace.com.au/

Sydney

https://tempkitchenrent.com.au/

Queensland

https://www.foodconnectshed.com.au/kitchen

Pilot Plant Services

CSIRO Pilot Plant facilities for hire Melb/Brisbane

https://www.csiro.au/en/work-with-us/industries/food/Facilty-hire

- Thermal processing including UHT processing, heat exchange technology and commercial scale overpressure retort.
- Evaporation, spray drying and particle sizing technology
- State-of-the-art pilot cheese manufacturing plant
- Fats, oils and emulsions processing technology including extraction, deodorisation and texturisation
- Emulsion technology including homogenisation and microfluidisation
- Packaging technologies including horizontal form-fill-seal modified atmosphere packing plant, aseptic packaging, tray packaging and vacuum/gas flush packaging
- Fillers, closer, ovens, coating system, mixers, bowl cutter, injector, smoking oven, grinding mills, jacketed scraped-surface kettle and more.

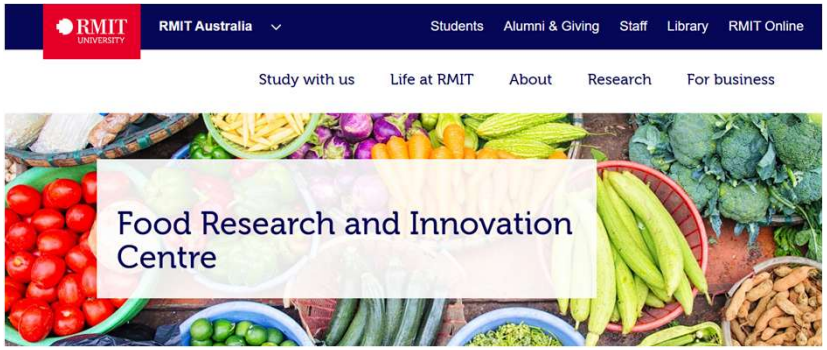
Pilot Plant Services

RMIT Food Research & Innovation Centre

Facilities

Our facilities include:

- food pilot plant
- product development laboratory
- fully-equipped, computerised sensory and consumer testing suite
- food and nutrition research laboratory
- food analysis and characterisation laboratory microbiology laboratory
- temperature controlled rooms
- dry goods storage
- dry and wet preparation areas



IN SUMMARY....

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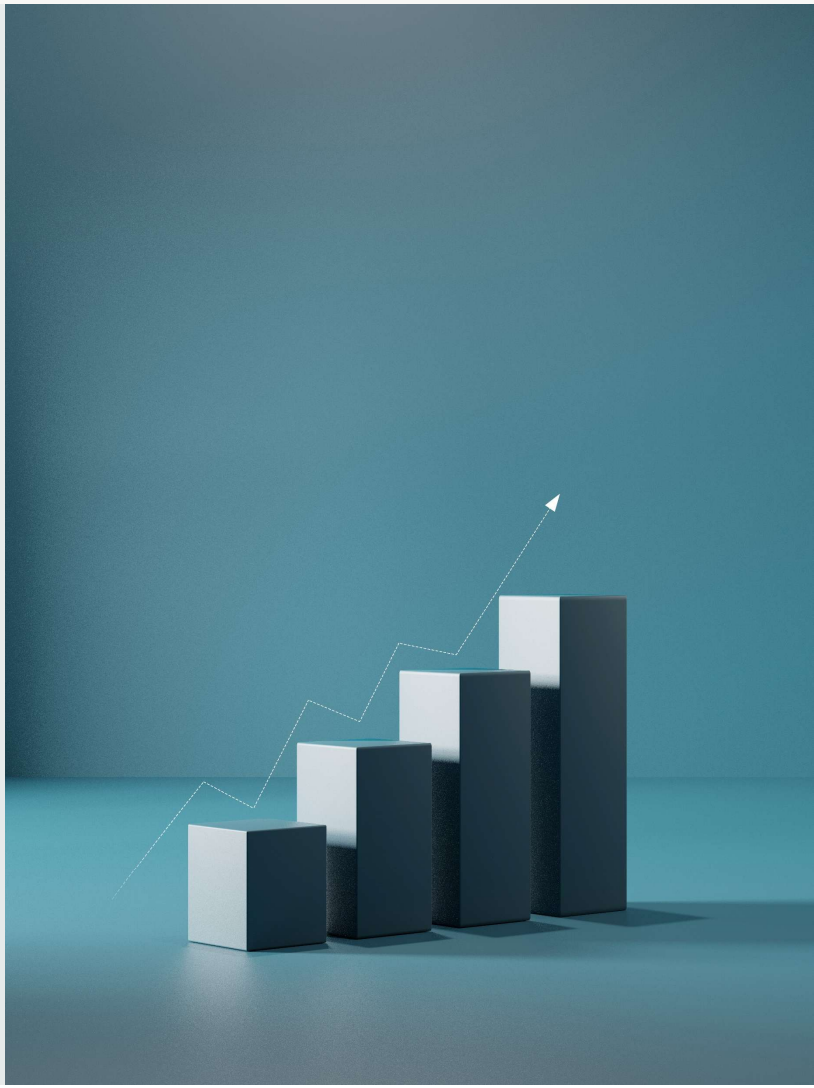
In Summary....

It's **time to consider scale up to commercial kitchen** when you are experiencing **consistent demand beyond home capacity**, need to **ramp up compliance,** have a **reliable cash flow**, and you are **turning down potential business**.

When moving from **Home Kitchen to Commercial Kitchen** it is important to consider complexities of **Recipe Scale Up, Ingredient Sourcing, Process** and compliance to ensure you continue to deliver a consistent, quality and safe product to your customers at the right price.

Do your homework when it comes to finding the right solution for you, whether it is sourcing the right **Commercial Kitchen or Pilot Plant Facility**, review the links on following slides.



REFERENCES, WHERE TO GO FOR MORE INFO...

Where to find ingredient and packaging suppliers - https://www.foodanddrinkbusiness.com.au/

FSANZ Guidelines for businesses including label compliance, NPC (Nutrition Panel Calculator) & labelling requirements: https://www.foodstandards.gov.au/industry/Pages/default.aspx

CSIRO Pilot Plant facilities for hire Melb/Brisbane: https://www.csiro.au/en/work-with-us/industries/food/Facilty-hire

RMIT Food Research & Innovation Centre

https://www.rmit.edu.au/about/our-locations-and-facilities/facilities/research-facilities/food-research-and-innovation-centre

For further support & assistance in improving your internal Innovation Process, you can visit www.foodfromthought.com.au

REFERENCES, WHERE TO GO FOR MORE INFO...

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Commercial Kitchens for rent & support in finding commercial kitchen solutions:

New South Wales (Sydney / Greater NSW)

Easy Kitchen - Hourly Kitchen Hire – Highly rated coworking kitchen in Sydney with flexible hourly/daily hire, suitable for food startups, catering, bakers, and prep kitchens.

My Commercial Kitchen – Top-rated shared commercial kitchen in Warriewood, ideal for small-to-mid sized food businesses and product prep. mycommercialkitchen.com.au

Temp Kitchen Rent – Excellent reviewer ratings for commercial kitchen hire in Ultimo, Sydney CBD area – flexible access and support options.

We Kitchens | Commercial Kitchen For Lease Sydney – Shared kitchen spaces focused on scalable brands and delivery-centric operations (e.g., ghost kitchens). wekitchens.com.au

Queensland

Cookhouse Commercial Kitchen – Highly reviewed shared kitchen in Fortitude Valley, Brisbane – supportive for food prep, catering businesses, and startups.

The Greenhive Kitchen - Commercial Kitchen hire Brisbane – Queensland shared kitchen option (mixed reviews but still an accessible facility for smaller operations).

Victoria (Melbourne & Surrounds)

Cooking Space – Melbourne's co-working/shared food manufacturing hub with multiple locations – flexible short- or long-term hire and local council pre-approval support. cookingspace.com.au

Cooking Space Port Melbourne – Another well-rated Cooking Space site in Port Melbourne for production and scaling.

South Australia

Adelaide Kitchen Hire – Fully compliant commercial kitchen for hire in Adelaide CBD, excellent for emerging food businesses.

Norwood Commercial Kitchen – Shared kitchen in Adelaide area, good for smaller producers and bakery/catering operations

Western Australia

Perth Kitchen Hire – Highly rated shared kitchen in Perth (Scarborough Beach Rd), providing compliant prep space for startups and deliveries.

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THANK YOU